

PROSPER AWUNI

IT Cyber Security Specialist | Security Controls, Architecture, Incident Response and Vulnerability Management

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a senior Cyber Security Specialist with over five years of experience taking ownership of cybersecurity controls and security architecture across large, complex enterprise environments. Holding the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification, I bring proven expertise in incident response, threat monitoring, vulnerability management, and Identity and Access Management (IAM). At the University of the Arts, London, I have operated as the subject matter expert for endpoint, identity, and email security, leading security operations for over 8,000 users across a hybrid cloud and on-premises estate. I am experienced in working closely with infrastructure engineering and technology teams to identify vulnerabilities, respond to incidents, and continuously strengthen the organisation's overall security posture. I bring a structured, risk-led mindset to every engagement and am adept at translating technical findings into clear, actionable guidance for both technical and non-technical stakeholders.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Cybersecurity Controls and Architecture:** Security control design, policy development, Zero Trust principles, Conditional Access, security frameworks alignment
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident lifecycle, end-to-end case management, containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review
- **Threat Monitoring and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management (SIEM)), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, KQL detection rule development, SOAR playbook automation, MITRE ATT&CK framework
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus, penetration test finding remediation
- **Endpoint Security:** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR/Prevent/Insight, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Email and Web Security:** Mimecast, phishing simulation, security awareness training
- **Endpoint and Mobile Management:** Microsoft Intune (Mobile Device Management (MDM)/Mobile Application Management (MAM)), Tanium
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, SOAR automation
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) | Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Take full ownership of cybersecurity controls across the enterprise, covering endpoint protection, email security, identity and access management, and vulnerability management for 8,000+ users.
- Work closely with Infrastructure Engineering and Technology Operations teams to identify vulnerabilities, prioritise remediation, and strengthen the overall security posture.
- Lead incident response operations following the NIST 800-61 framework, managing end-to-end investigations from detection through containment, eradication, and recovery.
- Oversee continuous threat monitoring using Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, developing KQL-based detection rules and SOAR playbooks to automate response to common attack patterns.

- Lead vulnerability management cycles using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), tracking findings to remediation and reporting posture improvements to senior stakeholders.
- Manage security architecture decisions for the IAM estate, including Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policy design, MFA rollout, and SSO configuration.
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover) for endpoint detection, response, and threat hunting across the full device fleet.
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) controls, including privileged account onboarding, session monitoring, and periodic access reviews.
- Deliver security awareness training and phishing simulations using Mimecast, measuring and reporting on user behaviour trends.
- Remediate findings from external penetration tests and contribute to ad-hoc security improvement projects aligned to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) | Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored security alerts and conducted threat analysis across SIEM, EDR, and email security platforms, escalating and managing incidents through to resolution.
- Supported full deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across the organisation, significantly improving threat visibility.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), configuring Conditional Access policies, managing MFA enrolment, and conducting identity governance reviews.
- Performed vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io, producing clear remediation reports and working with infrastructure teams to track patch deployment progress.
- Supported BeyondTrust PAM operations, assisting with privileged account lifecycle management and access reviews.
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts to streamline repetitive security tasks, reducing manual effort and improving consistency of controls.
- Contributed to security policy documentation and control mapping against CIS Controls and NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) requirements.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) | IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Delivered security engineering and infrastructure support in a SaaS and FinTech environment, with responsibility for endpoint security, network security, and identity access provisioning.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments across internal systems and supported timely remediation of identified risks.
- Monitored security events and assisted with incident triage, applying structured incident response procedures.
- Configured and maintained MFA and SSO controls to enforce secure access across cloud and on-premises services.
- Managed MDM policies to ensure device compliance before granting access to corporate systems.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Took full ownership of cybersecurity controls and security architecture for 8,000+ users at UAL, achieving measurable improvements in endpoint detection coverage, identity security, and vulnerability remediation velocity.
- Led end-to-end deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, establishing comprehensive threat visibility across the enterprise.
- Developed KQL-based SIEM detection rules and SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel that reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-frequency alert types.
- Implemented Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) into the vulnerability management programme, enabling continuous, evidence-based validation of security controls.
- Deployed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to achieve full auditability of privileged sessions, addressing a key audit finding and strengthening the access control framework.

- Reduced phishing-related incidents through targeted Mimecast policy tuning and security awareness training, with measurable reductions in simulation click-through rates.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)